

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 683

By Keisling

A RESOLUTION to honor the Children's Center of the
Cumberlands on its twenty-fifth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing an institution that is dedicated to improving the lives of Tennessee's children, our most precious natural resource, in a safe and welcoming environment; and

WHEREAS, the Children's Center of the Cumberlands in Oneida is celebrating its twenty-fifth anniversary of serving our most vulnerable children, and its satellite location in Jamestown is observing its twentieth anniversary this year; and

WHEREAS, under the leadership of executive director Angel Sexton, the Children's Center of the Cumberlands serves the community as a child advocacy center, providing direct mental health, medical, and prevention education services to the region's minor victims of physical and sexual abuse and neglect and drug-endangered children and their non-offending family members; and

WHEREAS, the Children's Center of the Cumberlands facilitates the diagnosis and treatment of injuries suffered by victims of child abuse, the collection of forensic evidence for legal purposes through the SANE medical program, and the provision of mental health and child and family counseling through a full spectrum of behavioral health services to improve clients' psychological wellness and quality of life; and

WHEREAS, for twenty-five years, the Children's Center of the Cumberlands has worked to assure the safety and overall well-being of children who have been abused or neglected by their parents or guardians, a noble calling that serves not only those children but the community at large by helping to rebuild their future; and

WHEREAS, children who have been subjected to harm deserve our compassion and understanding, but they also need the best available treatment to help them lead their best possible lives; and

WHEREAS, understanding the importance of this mission, the administration and staff of the Children's Center of the Cumberlands work hard every day to protect and serve child victims of abuse and neglect, and they are most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we join in commemorating the twenty-fifth anniversary of the Children's Center of the Cumberlands and thank the center's administration and staff for their ongoing commitment to Tennessee's most vulnerable children.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.